

V11 Virtual 2D Animation Team

Description & Eligibility

Teams will create a 2D computer animation, at least (1:30) and not exceed (2:30) minutes, based upon the provided topic. This national event will be submitted and judged virtually. Any middle level, secondary or postsecondary contestant may enter this event. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants. There are no restrictions on the number of entries per chapter or per state. Teams who do not submit an entry following the topic listed below, do not follow the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic

Create a 1:30 - 2:30 minute 2D Animated story of an object or character that becomes lost and ultimately finds its way back and was changed by the journey.

Competition Notes

- AI Policy Level 2 *Permitted with Citation*
- Contest Registration
 - Advisors register members for the event using the Membership Registration System, accessible at <https://register.bpa.org>.
 - Click on the “Conferences” tab and then select the “2027 National Virtual Events”.
 - There will be a \$20 fee for each team entry (*invoiced during event registration*).
 - Event registration can be purchased with your original invoice or with a new invoice after member registration.
 - The registration deadline is no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on December 1, 2026.
 - Contestants participating in the competition must be registered for the event prior to the submission deadline to be eligible.
 - Only the team captain should complete the submission.

Technical Pre-Submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Name(s)	National Deadline
Submit the following in one combined PDF: 1. Clickable URL to 2D Animation 2. Storyboard 3. Concept Art/Prototype 4. Works Cited 5. BPA Release Form(s) 6. AI Usage and Documentation Form	V11-TeamID.pdf	January 15, 2027, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

1. Demonstrate proficiency in industry-standard editing software applications to execute all phases of the 2-dimensional animation production process
2. Develop and sequence animation within a storyboard to communicate a clear and intentional visual narrative
3. Apply color theory, artistic effects, textures, and special effects to enhance the visual quality and creative impact of animated content
4. Demonstrate knowledge of transitions, audio, lighting effects, and the proper placement of titles and visual effects to produce a polished, professional final product
5. Demonstrate an understanding of audience analysis by designing and delivering a final animated product that effectively communicates to a defined target audience

Contest Specifications for this Event

- The team must create a 2D animation utilizing audio, text, video, and graphics.
- The team will research the topic using available references, time era and trends to develop a storyboard outlining the team's planned animation.
- Submit the URL to 2D Animation, Storyboard, Concept Art/Prototype, Works Cited, BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form in a combined PDF file to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on January 15, 2027. No changes can be made to the project after the date of submission.
- Advisors of qualifying teams will be contacted to reserve a time for a videoconference presentation before a panel of judges. The dates and times for presentation reservations will be announced via email notification. Teams will be assigned to sections prior to the preliminary presentation.
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions.
- The top teams with the highest cumulative technical and presentation scores will be invited to attend the National Leadership Conference to be recognized for their outstanding efforts and to participate in the National Showcase.

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- Team ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered contestants and/or those missing team ID cannot be accepted.
- The team is responsible for securing a BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.



V11 Virtual 2D Animation Team

Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team used 2D Animation Software.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to any question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Team submitted one (1) combined PDF file containing URL to 2D Animation, Storyboard, Concept Art/Prototype Works Cited according to the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i> , BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form.				/10
Complexity & Craftsmanship	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Asset Creation	Assets are mostly pre-made with little effort to customize or create original content.	Assets include a mix of original and pre-made elements, showing thoughtful integration.	Assets are primarily original and demonstrate creativity and effort in design.	/20
Attention to Animation Detail	Animation techniques lack precision or refinement, with noticeable errors or inconsistencies.	Animation shows attention to detail and uses techniques effectively.	Animation is highly refined, with exceptional attention to detail and technique.	/20
Technical Execution	Camera angles, timing, transitions, and techniques are poorly executed or misaligned with project goals.	Technical elements support the project objectives and are competently applied.	Camera work, timing, and transitions are expertly executed and enhance the project's impact.	/20
Animation	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Squash and Stretch	Movement lacks elasticity or realism; no clear illusion of weight or volume.	Movement shows basic squash and stretch to enhance realism.	Movement uses squash and stretch expertly to convey weight, volume, and impact.	/20
Anticipation	Actions occur abruptly with little or no preparation for major movements.	Movements include clear anticipation that prepares the viewer for key actions.	Anticipation is used effectively and creatively to enhance timing and viewer engagement.	/20
Staging	Actions are unclear or confusing, failing to communicate mood or intent.	Actions are clearly staged and communicate the intended mood or idea.	Staging is highly effective, enhancing clarity, emotion, and storytelling.	/20
Slow-In and Slow-Out	Movements are mechanical or unnatural, lacking smooth transitions.	Movements use slow-in and slow-out techniques to simulate natural motion.	Movements are fluid and lifelike, with expertly applied slow-in and slow-out.	/20
Secondary Actions	Animation lacks supporting details or dimension; secondary actions are missing or distracting.	Secondary actions are present and enhance the main movement.	Secondary actions are thoughtfully integrated, adding depth and realism to the animation.	/20

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Technical Scoring Rubric (Cont'd)

Composition	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Execution of Plan	Concept art and storyboard are unclear or disconnected from project objectives; planning lacks cohesion and detail.	Concept art and storyboard clearly support project objectives with a cohesive plan.	Concept art and storyboard are highly intentional, detailed, and creatively aligned with project goals.	/20
Writing Accuracy	Frequent grammar or spelling errors.	Contains some grammar or spelling errors.	Contains very few or no grammar or spelling errors.	/20
Creativity	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Originality	Animation lacks originality and relies heavily on familiar or reused ideas.	Animation includes original elements and shows creative thinking.	Animation is highly original, expressive, and showcases fresh, innovative ideas.	/20
Impact & Purpose	Animation fails to engage or fulfill its intended purpose.	Animation is memorable and effectively fulfills its objectives.	Animation is highly engaging, entertaining, and leaves a lasting impression.	/20
Lighting Use	Lighting is inconsistent or ineffective in supporting the animation.	Lighting is used appropriately to enhance the animation.	Lighting is used creatively and effectively to elevate the visual storytelling.	/20
Audio Quality & Sync	Audio is unclear or poorly synchronized, disrupting the animation experience.	Audio is clear and well-synchronized with the animation.	Audio is crisp, perfectly timed, and enhances the overall experience seamlessly.	/20
Transitions	Transitions are abrupt or distracting, affecting the flow of the animation.	Transitions are smooth and support the animation's flow.	Transitions are expertly crafted, enhancing the pacing and visual continuity.	/20
Final animation made effective use of time and was within the contest time limit of 1:30 to 2:30 minutes in length.				/20
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/330

V11 2D Animation Team

Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Stage Presence	Team lacks confidence or clarity; minimal eye contact, monotone voice, or poor engagement.	Team communicates clearly with good eye contact, voice inflection, and engagement.	Team is highly confident, expressive, and fully engages the audience throughout.	/20
Explanation of Development & Design	Development and design process is unclear or lacks connection to project goals.	Clearly explains pre-production, design choices, and target audience.	Thoroughly explains and connects all phases of development to project objectives.	/20
Technology & Techniques	Use of technology and techniques is vague or poorly explained.	Explains the use of software, tools, and techniques effectively.	Provides detailed, insightful explanation of innovative tools and techniques used.	/20
Media Elements & Assets	Media elements or assets are not clearly explained or connected to the project.	Explains how media elements and assets were used and developed.	Offers a comprehensive and engaging explanation of asset creation and integration.	/20
Team Roles	Roles of team members are unclear or not well defined.	Clearly explains each team member's role and contribution.	Provides a thoughtful and detailed explanation of team collaboration and responsibilities.	/20
Oral Presentation Quality/Style & Effectiveness	Presentation style is unclear, monotonous, or ineffective in delivering the message.	Presentation style is clear, engaging, and effectively communicates the message.	Presentation style is polished, dynamic, and powerfully enhances audience understanding and engagement.	/20
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/20
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/155

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT TEN (10) MINUTES